



ONE SHOT

REVISION SERIES

CLASS 10

CIVICS

OUTCOMES OF DEMOCRACY



Introduction

How do we assess democracy's outcomes? 🤔



Why to assess?



Because democracy is a better form of government when compared with others.

- Promotes equality among citizens.
- Enhances the dignity of the individual.
- Improves the quality of decision making.
- Provides a method to resolve conflicts.
- Allows room to correct mistakes.



Dilemma

Democracy is seen to be good in principle,
but felt to be not so good in practice



Do we prefer democracy only for moral reasons?



What may be achieved or not achieved under
each of these democracies will be very different.

We = Democracy = Our expectations ➡

It is just a form of government, it only
creates conditions for achieving something

Accountable, Responsive and Legitimate Government

Accountable

↓
Democracy = People

↓
Government elected by the people
should be accountable to the citizen

Is the democratic government efficient?

↓
Decision making

Democratic V/S Non-Democratic

- Democratic government follow procedures before arriving at a decision.
- Transparency in democratic government.

Responsive

↓
Meaning

↓
Responding to the needs and demand.

↓
Regular, free and fair elections;
open public debate on major
policies and legislations; and
citizens' right to information about
the government and its functioning.

↓
Outcome 🤔

Legitimate

↓
Which is highly valued.

↓
Not necessary that democratic
government is always satisfying.

↓
Then, why do we accept it?

↓
Because it is a legitimate
form of government.

↓
How 🤔

Economic Growth and Development

Expectations

Democracy = **Good government**



Then there should be development also.



Reality

Economic growth [1950 - 2000]

Dictatorship **↑**

Democracy **↓**

- **Then why didn't we reject democracy?**
 - Because economic growth depends on several factors. **[country's population size, global situation, cooperation from other countries, economic priorities]**
- **Reasons for acceptance of democracy?**
 - The difference in the rates of economic development between less developed countries with dictatorships and democracies is negligible.
 - It is better to prefer democracy as it has several other positive outcomes.

Reduction of Inequality and Poverty

Democracy and our expectation ➡ Reduction in economic inequality

More reasonable expected outcome? 🤔



- Democracies are based on **political equality** but **not on economic equalities**.
- A small number of ultra-rich enjoy a highly disproportionate share of wealth and incomes. || Those at bottom find it difficult to meet their basic needs.

Not very successful in reducing economic inequalities:

- Though the poor makes up a large proportion of our votes & no party would like to lose their votes, yet democratically elected government are not keen to address the question of poverty as we expect.

Accommodation of Social Diversity

Democracy

⇒ Our expectation ⇒ For a harmonious social life.



We can not reduce the social differences but we can accommodate it. ⇒ **Only in Democracy**

**Democracy must fulfil two conditions
in order to be accommodative.**



1. Majority needs to work with minority.
2. Rule by majority does not become rule by majority community in terms of religion or race or linguistic groups.

Democracy = Rule of Majority



This majority does not become rule of majority community in terms of religion or race or linguistic group, etc.



Every person or group should have a chance of being in majority.

Dignity and the Freedom of the Citizens

Democracy stands much superior to any other form of government in promoting dignity and freedom of the individual.



For societies which have been built for long on the basis of subordination and domination, it is not a simple matter to recognise that all individuals are equal.

But a democratic country provides a moral and legal force for the recognition of the principle of individual freedom and dignity.

Example: Women's claim, claims of disadvantaged and discriminated section



It is the recognition that makes ordinary citizens value their democratic rights. ➡

How?



➤ Examination of democracy never gets over 🤔

- As people get some benefits of democracy, they ask for more making democracy even more better.
- A public expression of dissatisfaction with democracy shows the success of the democratic project.
(Aware citizens have ability to expect and look critically at the power holders)



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